

achieve the same effect. When connecting to a computer over the Internet, things can get tricky, as both RDP and VNC are not very good at bandwidth management. Other software like LogMeIn.com and GoToMyPC.com are commercial options to connect to your computer using an extended and enhanced version of RDP / VNC. LogMeIn has a free version that provides basic remote Desktop functionality, but without the management features you would require if you are supporting multiple desktops.

8.3.19 ROI

Return on Investment. This is the magic number that finance managers like to ask for and IT geeks like to dodge. The return on investment is the only true measure of the cost effectiveness of your IT investments. However, the difficulty is in determining the parameters on which ROI will be calculated. This requires that any ROI measurement be pegged to some business driver that is suffering due to lack of technological support. The decision to use the business driver as the measure of ROI should be established through a consensus among the various project stakeholders. For example, a company may have a purchase process that is currently not efficient. A software has been identified which will improve the efficiency of the process. To calculate the ROI, we would first determine the cost of the current process and then compare it with the revamped process. The difference in cost between the two processes measured over a pre-agreed period of time will be the basis on which the ROI calculation will be worked out. However, this approach has its drawbacks, and in some cases where the change is not so readily visible, it may be that ROI is locked in to some secondary process.

8.3.20 SCM

Supply Chain Management. Company operations typically require that raw materials be bought from suppliers, be assembled or manufactured, and the finished goods despatched to customers. The entire link from supplier to customer is what is known as the supply chain. For organisations that want to create a competitive advantage, one of the areas of optimisation is the SCM segment